

Delaware County Council, February 24th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kle7Us3p3-c
Publication Date	2026-02-25T04:53:08Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Delaware County Municipal Meeting Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Hughes called the regular meeting to order [00:00:04](#), followed by the Pledge of Allegiance and roll call.
- **Attendance:**
 - Presiding Officer: President Hughes
 - Members present included: Miss Flangen, Mr. Whitehead (Dan), Miss Piper, Mr. Moble (referred to as Mmal/Smok/Smoke), Mr. Bookout, and Mr. Can (or Mr. Kz/Scans/Cheers). (Note: Transcript captures various phonetic spellings during roll calls).
 - Members absent: None explicitly stated.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Jim [00:00:06](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **December 16, 2025 Council Meeting Minutes:** Approved as corrected with minor submissions by President Hughes (Roll Call: Passed Unanimously / Approved by Voice Vote context within roll call [00:02:12](#)).

- **January 6, 2026 Special Council Meeting Minutes:** Approved with slight changes (00:02:27).
- **January 27, 2026 Council Meeting Minutes:** Corrected from a special meeting to a regular meeting, with individual breakdowns for transfers and appropriations explicitly added by Marissa (00:03:01).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:56 County General Transfer (Public Defender):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey, Office Administrator, Public Defender's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of funds to fund the LEAP copier lease agreement. Funds were budgeted but placed in the wrong account (-\$700 equipment, +\$700 rental lease equipment; total transfer zero).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously 00:04:49.
- **00:05:04 County General Transfer (Surveyor):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Liz / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer to pay the newly hired drainage board attorney out of contractual services (300 line) instead of employee line items (-\$6,219.00 attorney, +\$6,219.00 contractual services; total transfer zero).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously 00:06:23.
- **00:06:43 County General Appropriation (Commissioners - Workers' Compensation):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jenna / Commissioners' Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Additional appropriation of \$333,000 for workers' compensation insurance claims (Line 342). Staff explained that OpenGov autogenerated figures during budget time failed to account for actual unpredictable claims. The county is self-insured with a risk mitigation pooling plan. Last year's claims totaled over \$501,000 plus handling fees. Council members raised concerns regarding potential cash balance depletion before property tax settlements arrive.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed (Recorded individual roll call vote; President Hughes voted No; passed with majority support) 00:13:41.
- **00:14:09 County General Appropriation (Clerk - Deputy Registration):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Spangler, Delaware County Clerk.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$22 to correct a long-standing payroll ledger discrepancy affecting a deputy clerk's rate matching the prior year. Council

members expressed frustration regarding the frequency of minor early-year appropriations.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed (President Hughes voted No; passed with majority support) [00:15:47](#).
- **00:16:10 County General Appropriation (Courts - Circuit Court 1):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Judge Judy Calhoun, Delaware Circuit Court 1.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for a total of \$98,548 following the resignation of Court Administrator Emily Anderson (last day Feb 20). Requests included \$15,500 for PTO payout, plus funding for a new court administrator and an assistant position (full-time \$40k vs. part-time options). Debate centered around workweek hours (32.5 vs. 40 hours), the evolution of the administrator's role handling multi-department requests, and transition/training timelines.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to amend to approve **only** the \$15,500 court administrator PTO payout (Line 129-101): Approved via roll call [00:35:25](#).
 - Motion to amend FICA (\$1,186) and PERF (\$1,736) associated with the payout for a total of **\$2,922** (Lines 171 & 172): Approved via roll call (Mr. Scans voted No) [00:47:28](#).
 - Remaining requests (new administrative assistant / part-time positions) were **Tabled** to next month for further job description and financial documentation study [00:45:25](#).
- **00:48:03 County General Transfer (IT / Auditor):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$30,000 from Commissioners' IT contractual services (Line 146-311) to the Auditor's office contractual services (Line 126-311) to pay for IT support assisting the auditor, assessor, and treasurer. Total transfer zero.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously [00:49:27](#).
- **00:49:43 Appropriation Outside County General (High-Tech Crime Unit):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chuck Zimmers, Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of remaining 2025 funds (\$5,500 software maintenance, \$4,000 schooling/education; total \$9,500) into active spending lines.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously [00:50:26](#).
- **00:46:46 Appropriation Outside County General (Sheriff - Sex & Violent Offender Program):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy Marvin, Delaware County Sheriff's Office.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$12,000 (\$6,000 office supplies, \$6,000 communication) derived from fees collected via the Sex and Violent Offender Program to cover operating costs and device connectivity.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously
00:51:26.
- **00:51:38 Appropriation Outside County General (Cumulative Bridge Fund):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie D., County Highway.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for cumulative bridge funds to cover ongoing 2025 projects and bridge maintenance. An initial line item for Engineer salaries (\$13,400) was removed to be paid out of Commissioner's EDIT funds instead. Discussion covered federal/state reimbursements (80/20 splits), emergency repairs (such as Bridge 51 plating), and approximately 25 split bridge projects.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Amended to remove line 107-101 (\$13,400), adjusting the total to **\$1,072,162.24**. Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously
00:57:47.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:14:10 Rick Yenser** (Newsman, Author): Addressed the council regarding taxpayer funds, government spending restraint, and the importance of economic development focused on manufacturing jobs, citing the \$18M Muncie Power Products expansion and commercial growth compared to non-taxpaying entities.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Purdue Extension Office:** Amanda, Vicky Gasway, and Emily Cring provided updates on staff capacity, food insecurity metrics (16% in Delaware County), 4-H enrollment, the new Ag Academy with Delta and Monroe Central high schools, upcoming Ag Fest, and natural resource programming.
 - **Communication Center:** Fred presented a Motorola radio system proposal update, detailing a \$420,000 discount incentive if signed by March 16th, reducing the total initial equipment/integration cost to approximately \$720,000 (requested via DCRC) alongside fixed maintenance schedules across years 2-6 (\$869,000). Commissioners and council discussed fiscal feasibility and funding mechanics.
 - **Treasurer's Office:** Brad Pulk and staff introduced a proposed negative quitus procedure to clean up multi-year ledger/system encumbrance imbalances.
 - **Planning Commission / Building Commissioner:** Kylen Swackmer and Tom Fouch reviewed the 2025 annual report, noting 835 permits issued, \$178k+ returned to

county general, public notices for INDOT meetings (State Road 3 / CR 700 S), and success in addressing blighted/unsafe structures through owner cooperation.

- **Commissioners' Office:** Stephen Brand reported on continuous improvement cost savings initiatives, AEP free energy audits, USI property/liability insurance procurement savings, pharmacy benefit management reviews at the jail, telephone line audits reducing 75 unused lines, and fairgrounds utility structuring.
- **Adjournment:** Following an executive session announcement and scheduling the next regular meeting for **Tuesday, March 31, 2026, at 9:00 a.m.**, a motion to adjourn was made by Jessica and seconded by Dan, passing unanimously by voice vote **00:23:12**.

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-18 06:17:07 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.